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/ **Practice Exam - 1**

Correct Answer

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Practice Exam - 1

Question 116 of 117



A 66 year old man presents to clinic for his monthly follow-up. He notes feeling short of breath when walking to the bathroom and has difficulty dressing himself. He also complains of dyspnea and a persistent, nonproductive cough, even at rest. He says these symptoms have worsened over the past few days, though he denies any chest pain or neurological deficits. He states that he has been adherent to medications and has had no dietary indiscretions. The patient has a past medical history of HF with reduced ejection fraction (LVEF: 30%, NYHA III, Stage C), hyperlipidemia, type 2 diabetes, depression, renal insufficiency, central sleep apnea, and hypertension.

On physical exam, blood pressure is 145/95 mm Hg, heart rate is 58 beats per minute, and bilateral 2+ pitting edema is present below the knee. Pre-visit laboratories: B-type natriuretic peptide (BNP) 1021 pg/dL, HbA1c 7.0%, potassium (K) 4.3 meq/L, and digoxin level 0.9 ng/ml. His home medications include atorvastatin 40 mg once daily, carvedilol 25 mg twice daily, sacubitril-valsartan 97-103 mg twice daily, aspirin 81 mg once daily, glyburide 5 mg twice daily, hawthorn 450 mg twice daily, pregabalin 75 mg twice daily, sertraline 200 mg once daily, aripiprazole 10 mg at bedtime, nitroglycerin as needed, digoxin 125 mcg once daily, spironolactone 25 mg twice daily, and furosemide 20 mg once daily.

Which of the following medication could be exacerbating this patient's heart failure?

A. Hawthorn

 B. Aripiprazole

C. Sertraline

 D. Pregabalin

Commentary References

Testing Point: The Board-certified AHFTC specialist should recognize medications which could exacerbate or worsen heart failure.

Answer: D. Pregabalin

Pregabalin and gabapentin use in patients with heart failure has been associated with increased development of both peripheral edema and pulmonary edema, which is resistant to loop diuretics. The mechanism of the edema associated with pregabalin and gabapentin (in doses exceeding 1600mg/daily) is believed to be similar to that of a dihydropyridine calcium channel blocker, which affects the microvascular system, leading to lower-extremity edema, making Answer D correct.

Answer A is incorrect as hawthorn was evaluated in the SPICE trial and found to be safe in patients with HFrEF. While atypical antipsychotics such as apiprazole do have cardiovascular side effects such as QT prolongation, hyperlipidemia, worsening glucose control, and weight gain, this class of drugs have not been shown to directly exacerbate symptoms of heart failure, making Answer B incorrect.

Based on the SADHART trial, sertraline was found to be safe in patients with significant heart failure making Answer C incorrect.

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